BITWIG STUDIO CONTROLLER EXTENSION

AKAI
MPK Mini Plus II

BITWIG

All Modes

This document gives you a brief overview of the functions of the Akai MPK Mini Plus II with Bitwig Studio. For a detailed explanation of all controller functions, please read the MPK Mini Plus II user guide provided by Akai.

1 Note Input/Clip Control

The pads can be used to trigger notes or clips in the Clip Launcher, depending on the currently selected mode *(see Pad Modes on page 2).*

2 Remote Controls/Mixer Control

The knobs can be used to control parameters of the Remote Control pages or in the mixer, depending on the currently selected mode *(see Knob Modes on page 3).*

3 Track and Scene Select/Scene Launch

Turn the encoder to select the next or previous track. The 4x4 frame of the focussed area in the Clip Launcher will be moved horizontally.

Hold SHIFT and turn the encoder to select the previous or next scene in the Clip Launcher. The 4x4 frame of the focussed area will be moved vertically.

Press the encoder to launch or restart a scene.

4 Tap Tempo/Metronome

Tap the button repeatedly to set the tempo of the currently active Bitwig Studio project.

Hold SHIFT and press the button to toggle the metronome on or off.

5 Undo/Redo

Press UNDO to undo the last operation.

Hold SHIFT and press UNDO to redo the last operation.

6 Loop/Stop All

Press LOOP to toggle the Arranger Loop on or off.

Hold SHIFT and press LOOP to stop all currently playing clips in the Launcher.

7 Play/Stop/Continue

Press PLAY/STOP to start or stop the transport of Bitwig Studio.

Hold SHIFT and press PLAY/STOP to pause and continue playback from the same Arranger position.

8 Record

Press RECORD to toggle recording (when assigned to Arranger*) or Clip Launcher Overdub on or off (when assigned to Clip Launcher*).

9 Overdub/Quantize

Press OVERDUB to toggle Overdub in the Arranger or Clip Launcher on or off, depending on the record button assignment.*

Hold SHIFT and press RECORD to toggle Record Quantization between off and 1/16.

**You can change the assignment in the Controller Status Window (see the last page)*



Pad Modes

The Pads can be toggled between four different modes: Mute/Solo, Rec Arm/Stop Clip, Clip Launcher Mode, and Note Mode.

Pad Mode Select
Hold SHIFT and press PAD 1-4 to select a Pad Mode.

1 Mute & Solo Mode
Press an orange pad of the lower row to mute a track.

Press a yellow pad of the upper row to solo a track.

2 Record Arm & Stop Clip Mode
Press an red pad of the lower row to arm a track for recording.

Press an green pad of the upper row to stop a currently playing clip on that track.

3 Clip Launcher Mode
Clip Launcher Mode allows you to trigger clips in the Launcher of Bitwig Studio.

The currently focussed area of 4x4 pads will be visualized by a frame in the Clip Launcher. Press BANK A/B to toggle the pads between the upper and lower half of the 4x4 focussed area.

The pad colors correspond to the colors of the clips and their current status (green = playing, red = recording)

4 Note Mode
Note Mode allows you to trigger notes on an instrument loaded into a device chain in Bitwig Studio.

If the device chain contains a **Drum Machine** instrument, the pads will trigger the 16 instruments of the device.

Press BANK A/B to toggle the pads between the lower and the upper half of the drum cells.

If the device chain contains any other instrument device or VST, the pads will trigger notes with optional **scale support**.

Hold SHIFT and press the encoder to enter the note menu. These parameters are available:

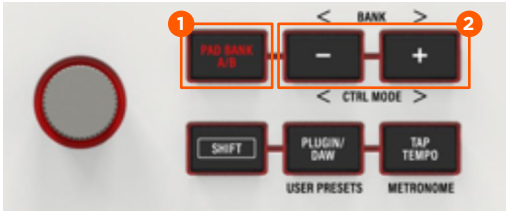
- **Scale**
- **Root Note** (will be highlighted on the pads)
- **Octave**
- **Pad Offset** (on Drum Machine tracks only)

While the note menu is open you can navigate tracks by holding SHIFT and pressing + or -.



Knob Modes

The eight knobs can be toggled between three different modes. In all modes the resolution of the knobs can be increased by holding SHIFT when turning a knob.



1 Knob Mode Select

Hold SHIFT and press BANK A/B to toggle between Remotes, Track, or Mixer Mode.

2 Device Select/Remote Page Select

Press - or + to select the previous or next device in the device chain.

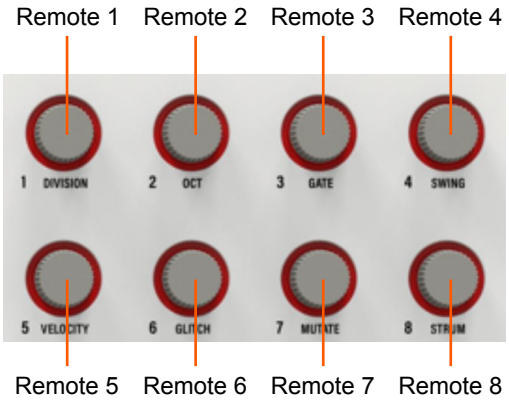
Hold SHIFT and press - or + to select the previous or next Remote Controls page of the currently selected device.

Remotes Mode

Remotes Mode allows you to control the remote controls of the currently selected device, the track, or the project remotes.

Press + or - to select the next or previous device in a device chain. The device name will be displayed in the second row of the display.

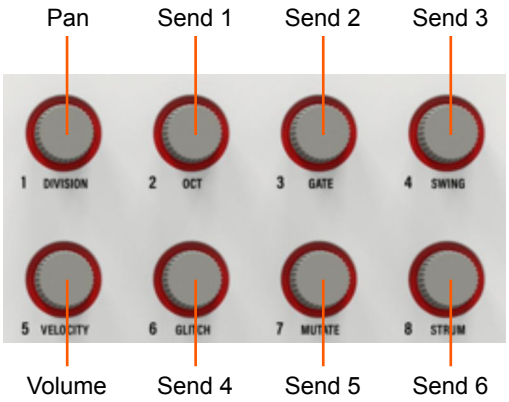
Hold SHIFT and press + or - to select the next or previous Remote Controls page. The page name will be displayed in the third row of the display.



Track Mode

Track Mode allows you to control the pan position, volume, and FX send levels of the currently selected track.

If a track contains more than six FX sends, hold SHIFT and press + or - to scroll through the FX sends (2-7, 3-8, etc.).

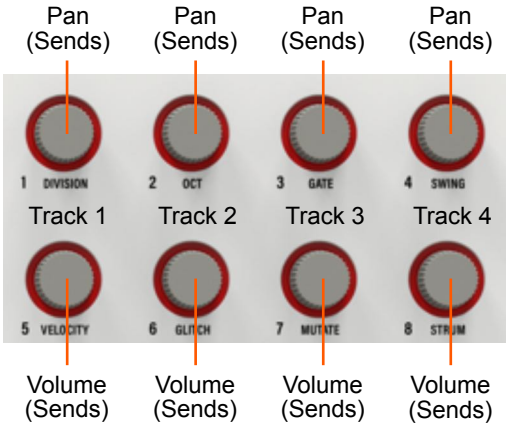


Mixer Mode

Mixer Mode allows you to control various mix parameters of the currently focussed bank of four tracks.

By default the top row of knobs is assigned to the pan position, the bottom row to volume.

Hold SHIFT and press + or - to toggle between pan/volume and FX sends.



Setup and Options

Setup

The MPK Mini Plus II should be detected and set up automatically when it is connected. If you add the device manually, make sure the correct MIDI ports are selected in the correct order.

Mac/Linux:
In 1: MPK mini Plus II DAW Port
In 2: MPK mini Plus II MIDI Port
Out 1: MPK mini Plus II DAW Port

Windows:
In 1: MIDIIN2 (MPK mini IV)
In 2: MPK mini Plus II
Out 1: MIDIOUT2 (MPK mini IV)

Synchronization

To synchronize the arpeggiator or note repeat of the MPK Mini Plus II to Bitwig Studio:

- On the MPK Mini Plus II hold SHIFT and press RECORD to open the global settings menu. Set Sync to Ext.
- In Bitwig Studio go to Dashboard > Synchronization and activate the following settings for the MPK Mini Plus II DAW Port:



Controller Status Window

When the MPK Mini Plus II is recognized by Bitwig Studio, a small keyboard icon appears in the top right corner of the application window. Clicking on this icon will open the controller status window.



You can change the record button assignment to toggle between recording in the Clip Launcher or the Arranger.

In the middle section the current knob assignment is shown. Pressing one of the pin icons lets you permanently assign the controls to certain parameters. For more information please read the Bitwig Studio user guide.